

Assumptions, corrections & scheduler status

Scheduler: third consecutive clean single fire — trigger fired once at 00:08:33 UTC, approx. 8 minutes after its 00:00 UTC slot; no duplicate, no gap. No trigger action needed. **Standing facts re-verified:** Kevin Warsh remains Fed Chair (sworn in 22 May 2026); the Jackson Hole Symposium runs Thu–Sat 27–29 Aug 2026 with Warsh's first keynote as Chair confirmed for Fri 28 Aug approx.10am ET — both unchanged from edition 6, re-checked fresh this edition. **Conflict resolved:** Nvidia's Monday close was reported as \$208.48, \$209.81 and \$210.16 by three different vendors; a targeted check traced \$209.81 to a mislabeled 10:58am ET intraday quote and could not corroborate \$210.16 against a clean OHLC table. **\$208.48 (–2.91%)** is used throughout, from a post-close market wrap independently corroborated by a second syndication. **Figure revised:** the dollar value of Canadian goods under Saturday's new 50% US tariff is reported at approx.\$28bn by two Monday sources, up from the approx.\$20bn figure carried previously; approx.\$28bn is used here as the more current, better-corroborated read.

60-second read

- 1. Chips sold off hard into Wednesday's Nvidia print.** Nasdaq –0.76%, semiconductor proxy SOXX –2.7%^[3]; Nvidia –2.91% to \$208.48 — a seventh straight losing session — with Micron –5.83% (fresh patent-litigation and China-competition overhangs), AMD –3.5% and Marvell –3.3%^[2,3,4,5]. Options now price a approx.6.2% implied move into Wednesday's close, down from approx.7.0% a week ago but still more than double the approx.2.8% historical average realized move — a genuinely two-sided setup, not a one-way bet^[54,55].
- 2. Bessent unveiled sweeping new Iran sanctions ("Operation Economic Outcast"),** targeting shadow-fleet oil buyers and financial channels across China, the UAE, Hong Kong, Singapore and Europe, with enforcement phased in to let counterparties comply first^[21,22,23]. Oil fell through the announcement — WTI –2.0% to \$85.29, Brent –1.7% to \$92.76 — as an economic-track escalation was read as lowering near-term war-premium even as Iran's security chief vowed "seismic" retaliation^[34,35,22].
- 3. Trump escalated the Canada trade fight,** threatening to double tariffs on Canadian autos and steel to 50% effective January 2027, on top of Saturday's already-live 50% tariff on approx.\$28bn of Canadian goods^[27,26]. USD/CAD rose approx.0.5% to 1.383, and the threat is a slow-burn overhang for cross-border autos/parts supply chains rather than a same-day equity catalyst^[48,49].
- 4. Treasury's doubled long-bond buyback kept pulling yields down and the dollar soft** — 10-year –3.5bp to 4.70%, DXY roughly flat near three-month lows — which, together with the Iran/tariff backdrop, pushed gold to a fresh COMEX high near \$4,706 (+0.55%) even without any fresh dovish Fed signal^[28,42,37]. Jackson Hole (Warsh's first keynote as Chair, Fri 28 Aug) and Wednesday's Nvidia print are now the week's dual focal points.
- 5. Dow +0.26% to 53,417 outperformed a soft tape** (S&P –0.28% to 7,652.86, Russell 2000 –0.76%) as consumer-defensive strength and a standout in travel (Expedia +5.44% on an analyst price-target raise) offset the chip-led tech weakness^[1,3,6]. Dick's Sporting Goods eased 2.13% into its own Tuesday-morning print (cons. EPS \$3.76)^[7,10].

1. Market recap

S&P 500 7,652.86 –21.51 / –0.28%	Dow Jones 53,417.16 +140.15 / +0.26%	Nasdaq Comp. 25,980.19 –200.26 / –0.76%	Russell 2000 2,995.08 –22.79 / –0.76%	VIX 15.90 +5.09%	10Y yield 4.70% –3.5bp
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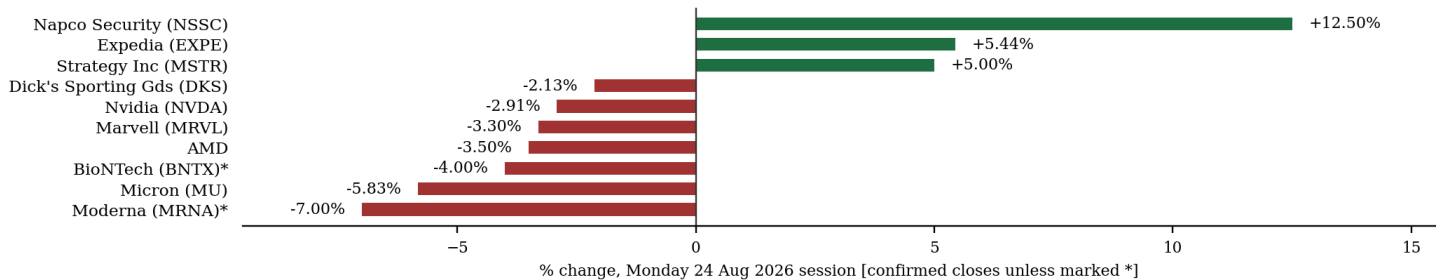
All four index levels are AP's confirmed Monday close, cross-checked against two independent market wraps that agree to the point^[1,2,3]. YTD: S&P +11.8%, Dow +11.1%, Nasdaq +11.8%, Russell 2000 +20.7%^[1]. Sector color (a full same-day 11-sector close remains unobtainable, as in every prior edition): consumer-defensive names led; energy and technology were the session's laggards, with chip names the weakest pocket inside tech — SOXX –2.7%^[3]. Treasury note: the 10-/2-/30-year levels below are secondary-market reads; the official Treasury.gov par curve for the session was not yet posted at cutoff.

2Y yield 4.23% –0.8bp	30Y yield 5.23% –4.7bp	WTI \$85.29 –2.0%	Gold (COMEX) \$4,706.30 +0.55%	DXY approx.98.8 +0.1%	USD/CAD 1.383 +0.5%
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Sources for this recap strip: ^[1,2,3,28,34,37,42,48] — full detail and citations in the sections below.

2. Equities and earnings

Chip complex led the market lower into Wednesday's Nvidia print. Nvidia fell 2.91% to \$208.48 — its seventh consecutive down session — as investors reduced risk ahead of Wednesday's after-market report^[2,3]. Micron was the session's worst mega-cap mover, –5.83% to \$910.43, on two fresh overhangs: memory-chip maker Netlist filed a new ITC exclusion-order request and federal patent suits against Micron over DDR5 RDIMM/MRDIMM products, and Chinese memory maker ChangXin Memory filed for a Shanghai IPO, stoking competition fears^[4,5,3]. AMD fell 3.5% and Marvell (which reports Thursday) fell 3.3%, both tracking the same complex-wide de-risking^[3]. The move set up Wednesday's Nvidia print as the week's dominant single-stock catalyst — see the derivatives section for the options-implied read.



Single-stock movers, Monday 24 Aug 2026 session. *Moderna and BioNTech figures are intraday (approx. 11:30am ET), not confirmed closes — see Annex A^[11].

Consumer discretionary/travel was the day's bright spot. Expedia rose 5.44% to \$339.13 on an analyst price-target raise^[6,3]. Dick's Sporting Goods eased 2.13% to \$179.33 in pre-earnings positioning ahead of Tuesday's 8am ET call; consensus into the print is EPS \$3.76 on revenue of approx.\$5.64bn, against a backdrop of expected margin compression from World Cup marketing spend and House of Sport pre-opening costs^[7,8,9,10].

mRNA-trade whipsaw continued — Moderna fell approx.7% to \$135.22 and BioNTech approx.4% to \$111.47 in profit-taking after Moderna's 392%-YTD run and last week's record high near \$176.66, with no new clinical catalyst behind the move (these are intraday reads, not confirmed closes)^[11]. **Crypto-proxy equities firmed** with Bitcoin's rebound toward \$71,000: Strategy Inc rose approx.5% to approx.\$125, with Bitcoin holdings now approx.846,000 (+11% quarter-on-quarter) against more than \$1.7bn cash^[12,13].

Earnings

Small-cap security-hardware maker **Napco Security Technologies** beat on both lines before Monday's open — revenue \$55.81M vs. \$52.55M consensus, GAAP EPS \$0.50 vs. \$0.39 consensus — and jumped 12.5% to \$42.87^[14,15]. **PDD Holdings** reported a mixed quarter: net profit of RMB27.18bn beat RMB24.40bn consensus but was down 12% year-on-year, while revenue of RMB112.36bn missed a consensus near RMB114–115bn, up 8% year-on-year; competitive pressure from Douyin/Xiaohongshu and a approx.€230m EU fine against Temu were cited as headwinds. The exact same-day stock reaction could not be confirmed from any dated source found (Annex A)^[16,17].

Analyst actions (Monday)

Firm	Name	Action	New PT
UBS	Celestica (CLS)	Buy from Neutral	\$430
Baird	Darden Restaurants (DRI)	Outperform from Neutral	\$250
Wolfe Research	PulteGroup (PHM)	Outperform	\$158
Baird	Chipotle Mexican Grill (CMG)	Neutral from Outperform	\$40
Baird	Domino's Pizza (DPZ)	Neutral from Outperform	\$350
BTG Pactual	Volaris (VLRS)	Neutral from Buy	\$9

Full list including initiations: Wells Fargo (Fortune Brands, Overweight, \$52), CICC (AstraZeneca, Outperform, \$198), JPMorgan (Roku, Neutral, \$160)^[18].

3. Macro, policy and rates

Bessent unveiled a sweeping new Iran sanctions campaign Monday, branded internally "Operation Economic Outcast" and described by Bessent as an "economic D-Day," at a Treasury press conference^[21]. The package expands secondary sanctions on financial and trade networks moving Iranian oil through the UAE, Hong Kong, China, Singapore, Switzerland and Europe, targeting brokers and shadow-fleet vessels and channels funding the IRGC-Qods Force^[22]. China, Russia, India, Pakistan, Qatar and Turkey were named as major continuing counterparties; enforcement is phased, giving countries time to cut ties before secondary sanctions — particularly on China — take effect, with Trump expected to personally contact world leaders^[23]. Iran's security chief vowed "seismic" retaliation, threatening tankers and Gulf export flows; the rial reportedly slid to a fresh low near 2 million/USD in anticipation^[22].

No Fed speeches were on the official calendar Monday^[20]. The September 16 FOMC remains a hold-vs-hike debate after July's 9–3 hold at 3.50–3.75% (Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissenting for a hike)^[58]; a live Polymarket read shows approx.68% no-change / approx.32% hike odds, essentially unchanged from Sunday's 69/31 split^[25].

Trump escalated the Canada trade fight, threatening to double tariffs on Canadian autos and steel to 50% effective 1 January 2027 and floating new tariffs on auto parts, on top of the 50% tariff on approx.\$28bn of Canadian goods that took effect Saturday after talks collapsed; auto executives were reportedly skeptical it will ultimately be implemented given past reversals^[27,26]. Prime Minister Carney's specific Monday response to the new auto-tariff threat could not be confirmed from an accessible source (Annex A).

4. Commodities and FX

Oil fell into and through the Iran-sanctions announcement, snapping a two-week rally (WTI and Brent had risen 5.7% and 6.4% the prior week) — WTI settled \$85.29 (–2.0%), Brent \$92.76 (–1.7%)^[34]. The move was read as economic-track escalation lowering near-term war-premium even though the underlying Hormuz shipping disruption, the latent bullish factor, is unchanged^[35]. Natural gas rose 2.06% to \$2.83/MMBtu on continued late-summer heat demand (single-sourced; no EIA storage data due until Thursday)^[36].

Gold pushed to a fresh high, approx.\$4,706–4,710 (+0.5–0.6%), as Treasury's doubled long-bond buyback (\$4bn/operation) pulled yields lower and softened the dollar, triggering short-covering in precious metals; intraday reads ranged \$4,648–4,712 across vendors^[37,38,39]. Silver eased approx.0.2–0.5% to approx.\$69, giving back some of last week's move above \$70^[39,38]. Copper traded \$6.60/lb (+0.29%, vendor feed) — a pullback from its session high but still holding well above the 12 August Comex record of \$6.7140, which stands as the last independently confirmed all-time high^[40,41].

The dollar was little changed near three-month lows (DXY approx.98.7–98.9) on the same Treasury-buyback theme^[42,43,44]. EUR/USD held near 1.168, touching a fresh three-month intraday high of 1.1710^[45]. The yen firmed approx.0.4% (USD/JPY approx.158.80) on rising conviction of a September BoJ hike^[46]. Sterling held just below Friday's six-month closing high near 1.3650–1.3675^[47]. USD/CAD rose approx.0.5% to 1.383 on the tariff escalation and firmer dollar^[48,49]; the Mexican peso firmed to 16.90/USD, near a two-year low for the dollar^[50].

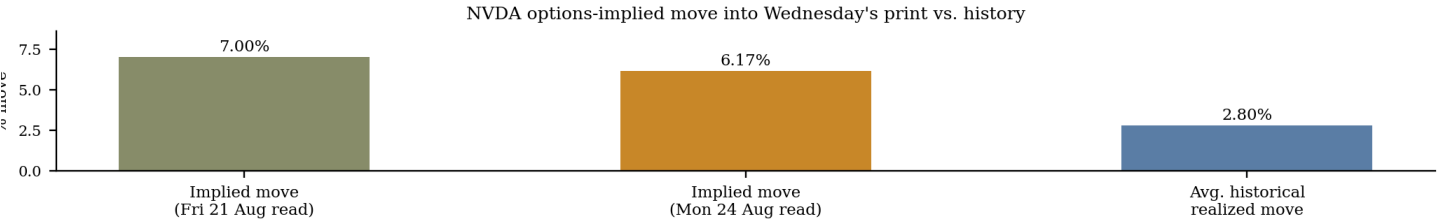
Instrument	Level	Chg	Instrument	Level	Chg
WTI crude	\$85.29	–2.0%	DXY	approx.98.8	+0.1%
Brent crude	\$92.76	–1.7%	EUR/USD	approx.1.168	flat
Nat gas (Henry Hub)	\$2.83	+2.06%	USD/JPY	approx.158.80	–0.4% (JPY firmer)

Gold (COMEX)	\$4,706.30	+0.55%	GBP/USD	approx.1.365	flat/soft
Silver	approx.\$69.0	-0.3%	USD/CAD	1.383	+0.5%
Platinum	\$1,884.45	n/a	USD/MXN	16.90	+0.3% (MXN firmer)
Copper	\$6.60/lb	+0.29%			

Levels are vendor/news-article prices, cross-checked across 2–3 sources where possible; none are exchange-confirmed settlements (Annex A). Sources: [34,36,37,39,40,42,45,46,47,48,50].

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

VIX closed 15.90, +5.09% on the session (a secondary read from two other vendors showed 15.85 — an immaterial spread, disclosed in Annex A), consistent with the broad equity pullback^[51,52]. VIX3M closed 18.56 (single-sourced)^[53], putting the VIX/VIX3M ratio at 0.86 — firm **contango**, ticking up slightly from Friday's 0.82 as front-month vol richened a touch faster heading into Wednesday's print and Jackson Hole. VVIX could not be confirmed for Monday specifically — the only source found carries an internally inconsistent date label and likely reflects Friday's level (Annex A).



Options-implied move sourced from TipRanks (Monday read) and the prior edition's Friday read^[54,55]; historical average realized move as carried in prior editions.

Nvidia options are pricing a approx.6.17% implied move into Wednesday's after-market print, down from approx.7.0% a week ago as the stock has fallen approx.6.7% over the same window, but still more than double the approx.2.8% historical average realized move — on Monday's \$208.48 close, that implied move is approx.\$12.86^[54,55]. Implied volatility on the stock stands at approx.41.3% against approx.36.1% historical volatility^[61]. Third-party dealer-gamma estimates for both Nvidia and the S&P 500 were available only as of Friday's close and are not treated as Monday-dated (Annex A).

Funding remained unremarkable. The most recent published SOFR print is Friday 21 Aug's 3.65%; Monday's had not yet posted at cutoff, consistent with the standard one-day lag^[56,57]. The ON RRP award rate held at 3.50%, unchanged since July's FOMC, with take-up still de minimis (last confirmed daily print, Friday: \$0.200bn)^[30,58]. The Fed's H.4.1 balance sheet was last updated 20 Aug for the week ended 19 Aug — reserve balances approx.\$2.935tn, TGA approx.\$953.6bn, total assets approx.\$6.746tn — with no newer release due until Thursday 27 Aug^[29,30]. CFTC Commitment of Traders data is unchanged from the 21 August release (data as of 18 August); the next release is due Friday 28 August with data as of 25 August^[59].

6. The day ahead — Tuesday 25 August 2026

Time (ET)	Event	Consensus	Prior
BMO, call 8:00am	Dick's Sporting Goods (DKS) Q2 FY26 earnings	EPS \$3.76 / rev. approx.\$5.64bn	EPS \$4.38 (Q2 FY25)
approx.9:00am	S&P Case-Shiller home prices (June)	—	—
10:00am	Conference Board Consumer Confidence (Aug)	90.3	90.8
10:00am	New-home sales (July)	—	—
10:00am	Richmond Fed Manufacturing Index (Aug)	approx.+6 to +7	+5

Sources: [9,10,31,32,60].

This week's known catalysts

Date	Event
Wed 26 Aug	Q2 GDP (2nd estimate), July durable goods orders, July PCE / core PCE — all same session; Nvidia Q2 FY2027 earnings, AMC, call 5pm ET
Thu 27 Aug	Jackson Hole Symposium opens (through Sat 29 Aug); Marvell earnings, AMC; Fed H.4.1 balance sheet (week ended 26 Aug)
Fri 28 Aug	Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote as Chair, approx.10:00am ET

Sources: [33,60,19].

Sector setup we take into Tuesday

- **Chip/AI-hardware:** de-risked into Wednesday — Nasdaq, SOXX, Nvidia, Micron, AMD, Marvell all fell Monday; the approx.6.2% implied move is more than double the historical realized average, a two-sided setup.
- **Consumer discretionary/travel:** Monday's bright spot (Expedia); Dick's Tuesday print is the next read into the holiday season.
- **Rates-sensitive assets/gold:** the bond-buyback program keeps capping long yields and supporting gold without a dovish Fed signal — likely to persist into Jackson Hole.
- **Autos/industrials:** the new Canada auto-tariff threat (50% from Jan 2027) is a slow-burn overhang, not a same-day catalyst; watch guidance at upcoming industrial prints.

Annex A — Could not be verified this edition

- Coinbase (COIN) and MARA Holdings' Monday % moves — no Monday-dated article found despite repeated searches.
- PDD Holdings' exact same-day stock-price reaction — direction/context only ("struggling despite the beat"), no precise % found.
- Full same-day 11-sector GICS closing table and closing breadth — persistently unobtainable.
- PHLX Semiconductor Index (SOX) −3.6%/"bear market" claim — single-sourced, lower-confidence; SOXX −2.7% used instead.
- Telecom sector (AT&T/Verizon/T-Mobile) Monday-specific moves — no dated article found.
- Individual consumer-staples names (Walmart, Costco, P&G, Coca-Cola) Monday moves — only the sector-level "defensives led" read found.
- Industrials (Caterpillar, Boeing, GE Vernova) Monday moves tied to the tariff story — named as high-volume but no percentages found.
- Platinum's % change on Monday — only the level (\$1,884.45) is sourced.
- Exact date of copper's reported \$6.83/lb all-time high — a vendor page cites "August 2026" without a specific date; last independently confirmed record remains 12 Aug at \$6.7140.
- Natural gas figure is single-sourced (TradingKey); a second source could not be fetched.
- GBP/USD's exact daily % change — only levels/ranges found.
- VIX3M's Monday close (18.56) — single-sourced; no independent second source located.
- VVIX for Monday specifically — source's date labelling is internally inconsistent; best available reflects Friday's approx.86.3 level, not confirmed for Monday.
- CBOE daily put/call ratio, MOVE index, VIX9D and VIX6M numeric closes — persistently unavailable (known structural limitation).
- Dealer gamma/GEX for Nvidia (approx.+\$72.8bn) and the S&P 500 (approx.−\$10.9bn) — both are third-party estimates last updated Friday, not Monday-dated; the S&P figure's own source showed an inconsistent live reading on a second check.
- Monday's SOFR print and Monday's ON RRP daily take-up — not yet posted at cutoff (standard one-day lag).
- Prime Minister Carney's specific Monday statement responding to the new auto-tariff threat — source article was blocked on fetch; only the headline was visible.
- The dollar value of Canadian goods under the new 50% tariff — reported at approx.\$28bn by two Monday sources versus approx.\$20bn in a prior edition; approx.\$28bn used as the better-sourced current figure, but not fully reconciled.
- Exact same-day % change for Moderna, BioNTech and Merck — the sourced figures (−7%/−4%/−1%) are an approx.11:30am ET intraday snapshot, not confirmed closes.

Annex B — Sources

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Method note

Produced by an AI research process. Every figure above is sourced to a named, dated publication; none are estimated, inferred, or filled from memory. Where sources disagreed, the more authoritative was used and the disagreement disclosed inline or in Annex A. Session-date confusion (aggregators republishing a prior day's data) was actively checked for and one instance was caught and discarded (a Yahoo Finance page republishing Friday 21 Aug's closes under Monday's headline). This is descriptive market coverage, not investment advice, and carries no portfolio tilt.